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An Assessment of the Impact of Sticky Floors and Glass Ceilings in Lebanon

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Abstract

Understanding earning gaps prevailing among genders is related to the efficiency in the labor market. Arguing that skills, productivity of individuals, and their commitment to work will ultimately determine individuals incomes sounds too naïve to explain the earnings differential between males and females. In fact, discrimination against females could occur at different stages of their career path. The wage gap is apparent at the top (glass ceiling) as well as at the bottom (sticky floors) of wage distribution. This paper intends to explore earning gaps as a function of the characteristics of existing Lebanese human capital and labor productivity in selected white-collar jobs within a large institution of the service industry. Outcomes of the research will lead to explore the impact of automatic stabilizers or self-correcting mechanism in the Lebanese labor market to reduce gender disparity and to discuss whether government intervention is called for.

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1. Introduction

Arguing that skills, productivity of individuals, and their commitment to work will ultimately determine individuals incomes sounds too naïve to explain the earnings differential between males and females. In fact, discrimination against females could occur at different stages of their career path. Blau and Khan (2006) argue that women continue to encounter discrimination in the labor market and that even though the tendency is decreasing; it has not been fully eliminated. Moreover, they add that women's wages continue to be considerably less than those earned by men of similar qualifications. In a recent study made in Switzerland, Dacey (2012) considered a sample of 1100 professionals (85% were women) and came up to the results that 79% of the women believed that gender is a determinant factor in career advancement, and 73% of the women respondents agreed that there are barriers to women advancement in upper management within Switzerland. Similarly, in their debate related to women's discrimination in the job market; Barreto, Ryan, and Schmitt (2009) stated that women continue to be underrepresented in key corporate positions and that even after the political and legislative reforms undertaken within the large world economies, women's job status is still unclear. The gender pay gap continue to persist as declared by Dugas (2012) where she reasons that among recent college graduates, women working full-time do earn

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82% of what similar men earn. In another part of the globe, specifically in Pakistan, Channar (2010) concluded that females were discriminated more than males in the majority of the salary groups within job markets, and that females faced discrimination not only from bosses but also from their peer colleagues at the work place.

Moreover, Fitzpatrick (2010) stated that in 2008, women in the USA did earn 77 cents compared to a male dollar, thus indicating a gap of 23%. Correspondingly, Eagly and Sczesny (2009) based on a 2007 report by the European Commission, quoted that in each of the 27 nations of the European Union, women discrimination is apparent when they average only 4% of the presidents and 10% of the members of the highest decision making bodies.

The wage gap scenario does not look so pessimistic to other researchers whose studies had shown that the aforementioned gender gap seems to be declining over time without being eliminated. According to Blau and Khan (2000), as of 1978, the wage disparities between men and women in the USA have been following a decreasing tendency that is expected to continue keeping the declining rhythm during the years to follow. Similar findings were reported by Kolesnikova and Liu (2011) by quoting that the earnings gap between genders have dropped to around 16.5 in 2011 after being 23.75 in 1999 and 30% in 1989. Furthermore, the US Department of Labor (2009) went differently by reporting that despite the narrowing of the wage gap witnessed during the past years; this gap continues to be used in confusing ways to support public policy agendas without fully clarifying the rationale behind the gap. The report adds that there is no need to use the wage gap to justify corrective action since there could be nothing to correct if the wage gap arises from personal individual choices made by male and female workers.

Discrimination against females can occur at different stages of their career path. Some argue that the discrimination will start upon the arrival to the labor market where according to Channar (2010), sticky floors arise due to the appointment of similar men and women at the same rank, but with men put at higher favourable scale. Others (Cotter, Hermsen, Ovadia, & Vanneman, 2001) state that there is an unseen barrier called a glass ceiling that will prevent females from rising to the upper rungs of the organizational ladder even with credentials or achievements. According to Barreto et al (2009), glass ceiling is used to refer to the fact that men dominate the upper strata of the managerial pyramid. Likewise, Wirth (2001) states that qualified females look through the glass ceiling having in mind the potential they carry and own but are not capable to break through the invisible artificial barriers formed by attitude and organizational prejudices.

Both sticky floors and glass ceilings have been extensively considered when performing wage gap studies. Bjerk (2008) suggests that the under-representation of females at higher managerial levels is more due to sticky floors than glass ceilings. The results from the European Union reported by Christofides, Polycarpou, and Vrachimis (2010) show that the wage gap in most of the nations of the EU is wider at the top of wage distribution thus implying a glass ceiling. Equally, Yurtoglu and Zulehner (2009) using wages of top executive officers of publicly listed US firms concluded after controlling for individual and firm characteristics that the estimated pay gaps suffer a sticky floor effect and that females at the top of organizational ladders experience less discrimination than lower paid female managers.

The Lebanese labor market has been studied by Dah and his collaborators (Dah, Ben Sita, & Dah, 2009) and they concluded that men earn 16% more than women even after controlling for factors such as education, experience and job category. In another study, Dah (Dah, Kassir, & Dah, 2009) shows that in Lebanon, the odds for promotion for men as compared to women increase as they move towards the top. In fact, according to the Global Gender Gap Index (OECD Development Centre, 2011), the Gender Inequality Index score is 0.440 placing Lebanon at 76 out of 146 countries.

This research paper will be questioning the presence of automatic stabilizers in labor markets to reduce gender disparity. If automatic stabilizers exist, then there is no need for government intervention and any discrimination against females upon arrival to the labor market will be eliminated by fair promotion practices. These fair promotion practices must depend solely on the presence or availability of human capital and labor productivity. That is, the

presence of a sticky floor in the labor market will eventually be balanced by non-discriminatory practices and no need for government ruling to protect the unprivileged group. Likewise, the presence of a glass ceiling that prevents females from climbing the corporate ladder and increases the income differential between males and females opens the door for government intervention to reduce the income gap between males and females.

The works of Vecchio, Scuffham, Hilton, & Whiteford, H. A. (2013), Still (1997), and the US Department of Labor (2009) among many others studying the income differential between males and females emphasize the importance of different job conditions in explaining at least partially the earnings gap. In parallel, this paper investigates the existence of the earnings gap in a white collared job. Specifically, to control for work conditions and the choice of career path, this research utilizes recent and comprehensive data that covers all the employees in two large institutions in Lebanon. The study examines whether there is an earning differential upon arrival to the labor market. Put differently, the research tests the validity of the presence of a sticky floor and thus calls for some automatic stabilizers that tend to reverse the initial cultural bias that exists upon appointment. The absence of self correcting mechanisms in the labor market needs government intervention to protect the career paths of females. Such measures are required to overcome the presence of glass ceiling that makes it more difficult for females to climb the organizational ladder.

2. Data and Models

This research relies on two main sources of data brought from the Lebanese banking sector. The Lebanese banking sector is considered the key sector of the Lebanese economy, accounting for 35% of GDP growth (ALPHA, 2011). The first source is the full personnel of a major bank with a work force of 633 persons covering all the business levels, while the second source correspond to a smaller banking business with 323 employees also at all levels. The data extracted for each employee from the respective human resource departments are:

- Earnings: Annual earnings of an individual in USD.
- Experience: Years in the field of work.
- Education: One of the six levels of education; illiterates, primary and intermediate, secondary, diploma, university, or graduate.
- Gender: Female or male.

The complete proposed econometric model that relates earnings to the explanatory variables of experience, education and gender can be written as follows:

The earnings are related to the independent variables through a natural logarithm as suggested by classical econometric references (Wooldridge, 2009). The explanatory variables are: Experience which represents the individuals' years of experience. Education, which is a vector of dummy variables used to signal different levels of education. (Illiterate=0, primary& intermediate=1, secondary=2, diploma=3, university=4, and graduate degree=5). Gender is a binary variable that takes the value of one for a male and zero for a female. In the aforementioned econometric model, the "Beta" coefficients possess a percentage interpretation and they have a "ceteris paribus" explanation (Wooldridge, 2009).

Because our study is related to the assessment of the impact of 'Sticky Floors' and 'Glass Ceilings', experience will play a major role in the regressions. Moreover, to account for non-linear relationships with experience, the inclusion of a squared experience term is considered as suggested by Wooldridge (2009). Thus the aforementioned regression model may be augmented by adding an "Experience²":

Different regression equations using subsets of the original data, based on the individual years of experience, will be compared in an attempt to study the value of the gender coefficient in each subgroup. Absence of market correcting mechanisms will be evident if the gender gap, as measured by the Gender coefficient, is growing with experience level and government intervention is therefore needed.

Prior to performing the regressions, some descriptive analysis of the data at hand will be exposed with the aim of presenting a clear image of male and female earnings under different levels of education and experience in both the middle size and small size banking businesses.

3. Results

3.1. Descriptive Analysis

The statistical yearbooks of Lebanon show that the banking population in the Lebanese banking sector has grown from 15,268 persons with 42.8% females in 2003 (Central Administration for Statistics, 2007), up to 18,632 persons with 45% females in 2008 (Central Administration of Statistics, 2008). In our case, the analysis of data is performed on 956 working individuals' records that correspond to the full working force at two banking institutions within Lebanon. Again, the statistical yearbooks of Lebanon show that in 2008, in Lebanon there were 64 banks of which 81.2% were commercial banks and 18.8% were business banks (Central Administration of Statistics, 2008). The research data comes from a middle size bank with 633 employees (376 males and 257 females) having 40.6% females, and from a small size bank with 323 employees (196 males and 127 females) having 39.32% females.

Table 1. Annual Salary, Age, and Experience by Gender

Gender, N, %		Annual Salary in USD	Age	Experience
Females, 384, 40.17%	Mean	14,722	39	14
	Median	11,694	41	13
	Std. Deviation	9,264	11	10
Males, 572, 59.83%	Mean	19,285	43	15
	Median	12,564	44	17
	Std. Deviation	19,170	11	10
Males + Females, 956, 100%	Mean	17,452	41	15
	Median	12,186	42	15
	Std. Deviation	16,098	11	10

From Table 1, the annual average earnings of the individual within the data at hand turned out to be USD17, 452 and the annual median income is USD 12,186. The annual average earnings of males is USD19, 285 as compared to USD14, 722 for females. The median annual income for males is USD 12,564 and USD 11,694 for females. The average age of males is 43 years while that of females is 39 years. Likewise, the average experience for males is 15 years while that of females is 14 years, and the median experience for males is 17 years compared to 13 years for females. Moreover, the combined data of both banks indicates that the quartile divisions are 4, 15 and 22 years for the first, second and third quartiles respectively.

In actual fact, the mean and median earnings presented in Table 1 portray an image of the wage gap that exists within considered banking businesses.

Moreover, results show that the annual average earnings of an individual within the small bank is USD 18,698 and the annual median income is USD12, 528. The annual average earnings of males is USD 20,686 as compared to USD15, 629 for females. The median annual income for males is USD 12,762 and USD 12,295 for females.

Therefore, such data reveals another view of the wage gap discrimination that prevails within the considered small bank.

As for the middle size bank, results show that the annual average earnings of an individual within the middle size bank is USD 16,816 and the annual median income is USD11,900. The annual average earning of males is USD 18,554 as compared to USD 14,274 for females. The median annual income for males is USD 12,467 and USD 11,340 for females. Data again disclose similar scenes between the two banks; a wage gap discrimination exists within the considered medium bank.

When comparing the employees' educational levels in the two banks, results show that higher education dominates within all educational levels. To clarify this domination, a comparison of the percentages of males and females at each educational level is presented in Tables 2 and 3 which shows that the bachelor level constitutes the highest percentage among the employees within both banks.

Table 2. Education Level in Middle Sized Bank by Gender

		Education Level					Total
		Primary & Intermediate	Secondary	Diploma	Bachelor	Graduate	
Gender	F	16.949%	45.399%	32.394%	45.105%	38.889%	40.600%
	M	83.051%	54.601%	67.606%	54.895%	61.111%	59.400%
	Total	9.32%	25.75%	11.22%	45.18%	8.53%	100%

Table 3. Education Level in Small Sized Bank by Gender

		Education Level					Total
		Primary & Intermediate	Secondary	Diploma	Bachelor	Graduate	
Gender	F	9.80%	27.78%	33.33%	56.67%	61.54%	39.32%
	M	90.20%	72.22%	66.67%	43.33%	38.46%	60.68%
	Total	15.79%	22.29%	16.72%	37.15%	8.05%	100%

Table 2 corresponds to the middle size bank. It shows that percentages of educated males are larger than the percentages of educated females under all the educational levels. However, Table 3, which corresponds to the small bank, shows that under the highest two levels of education: "Bachelor" and "Graduate", the percentages of females are higher than those corresponding to males. Indeed, at the university bachelor level, there is 56.67% for females compared to 43.33% for males, and at the graduate level, there is 61.54% for females compared to 38.46% for males.

In order to have a better image of the interaction between gender, education and experience on one hand, and the corresponding annual salaries on the other hand, Table 4 is considered where experience was categorized based on the quartile divisions being 4, 15 and 22 years for the first, second and third quartiles respectively. Table 4 presents the mean salary and its standard deviation for the 956 employees classified by educational level, experience category and gender. It is shown that in general the average annual salaries under all educational categories are larger for males when compared with females. A few exceptions can be noticed in the highlighted cells of Table 4 where in these the average salaries corresponding to females are larger than those of males. Looking at these three cases carefully, it can be noticed that the first case at the primary and intermediate level of education is not meaningful since the number of female records is just one record so the mean is not representative of the group. The second case where the female's mean is USD 17,834 and the males mean is USD 12,697 occurs under the primary and intermediate level of education where there are 7 female records and 30 male records. Here, references for statistical tests (Hejase & Hejase, 2013) indicate that these means are significantly different at 5% level of significance; however the size of the female group weakens the acceptability of this result.

Similarly, Table 4 shows a third case that occurs under the category of experience between 4 and 15 years resulting from 17 female records and 32 male records. Performing a test for the significance of the difference indicates that at 5% level of significance the females' mean USD 12,635 and the males' mean 10,954 are not significantly different.

Table 4. Years of experience, Gender, and Salary by Level of Education

Education	Experience (years)	GENDER	N	MEAN (USD)	STD (USD)
Primary & Intermediate	Experience ≤ 4 years	F	3	9,635	3,707
		M	12	9,769	14,884
	4 < Experience ≤ 15 years	F	1	19,652	.
		M	25	10,283	11,393
	15 < Experience ≤ 22 years	F	4	10,125	3,455
		M	28	11,256	9,649
	Experience > 22 years	F	7	17,834	4,222
		M	30	12,697	3,182
Secondary	Experience ≤ 4 years	F	9	6,915	1,072
		M	15	9,041	9,965
	4 < Experience ≤ 15 years	F	17	12,635	6,389
		M	32	10,954	12,223
	15 < Experience ≤ 22 years	F	33	11,468	2,281
		M	50	12,522	3,844
	Experience > 22 years	F	35	18,457	7,471
		M	44	26,796	41,159
Diploma	Experience ≤ 4 years	F	7	14,834	10,369
		M	8	21,344	20,686
	4 < Experience ≤ 15 years	F	14	14,106	11,962
		M	21	19,125	17,569
	15 < Experience ≤ 22 years	F	14	13,031	2,690
		M	29	19,609	10,661
	Experience > 22 years	F	6	18,232	12,008
		M	26	26,545	12,986
Bachelor	Experience ≤ 4 years	F	86	8,339	4,946
		M	84	11,458	9,912
	4 < Experience ≤ 15 years	F	48	13,072	7,482
		M	48	23,045	18,747
	15 < Experience ≤ 22 years	F	32	17,527	6,269
		M	38	28,711	17,258
	Experience > 22 years	F	31	26,670	7,324
		M	39	35,486	17,009
Graduate	Experience ≤ 4 years	F	5	17,501	21,926
		M	14	22,094	23,514
	4 < Experience ≤ 15 years	F	26	19,678	10,415
		M	18	28,178	15,286
	15 < Experience ≤ 22 years	F	2	24,996	1,107
		M	4	36,778	26,071
	Experience > 22 years	F	4	40,833	15,429
		M	7	47,266	16,101

The point to emphasize here is that comparing the average salaries of males to those of females while controlling for education, leads in general to the conclusion that males' average salaries are significantly higher than those of females under all experience categories keeping in mind that the couple of exceptional cases presented cannot break the emphasis.

3.2. Ordinary least-squares regression

As previously mentioned, the regression model to study the impact of gender, experience and education level on salary is:

$$\ln(\text{Earnings}) = \beta_1 + \beta_2 \text{Experience} + \beta_3 \text{Education} + \beta_4 \text{Gender} + \beta_5 \text{Experience}^2 + \varepsilon$$

Table 5 shows the results of the regressions performed on the data at hand where it is worth mentioning that when exclusively female or male data is considered, then the gender term is excluded from the regression and thus no value exists for the coefficient ' β_4 '.

Table 5. Table of Coefficients

Source of regression data	N	β_1 p-value	β_2 p-value	β_3 p-value	β_4 p-value	β_5 p-value	R ²	Adjusted R ²
Females in medium bank	257	8.219 0.000	0.045 0.000	0.193 0.000		0.000 0.333	0.543	0.538
Males in medium bank	376	8.002 0.000	0.050 0.000	0.296 0.000		0.000 0.246	0.443	0.438
Females plus males in medium bank	633	7.976 0.000	0.047 0.000	0.260 0.000	0.155 0.000	0.000 0.333	0.476	0.472
Females in small bank	127	8.619 0.000	0.038 0.016	0.107 0.007		0.000 0.976	0.394	0.379
Males in small bank	196	8.190 0.000	0.047 0.004	0.294 0.000		0.000 0.602	0.344	0.333
Females plus males in small bank	323	8.107 0.000	0.043 0.000	0.239 0.000	0.238 0.001	0.000 0.785	0.335	0.327
Females in medium and small banks	384	8.323 0.000	0.044 0.000	0.169 0.000		0.000 0.330	0.492	0.488
Males in medium and small banks	572	8.100 0.000	0.050 0.000	0.284 0.000		0.000 0.152	0.392	0.389
Females plus males in medium and small banks	956	8.039 0.000	0.047 0.000	0.247 0.000	0.185 0.000	0.000 0.146	0.476	0.472

Regressing $\ln(\text{Earnings})$ as a function of all the selected variables aims at determining the gender bias in the banking labor market after controlling for education, and experience years. The results presented in Table 5, show that most of the "Betas" of independent variables are significant at the 5% level of significance except for ' β_5 ' related to the square of the experience which is an indication of a weak nonlinear relationship with experience. Furthermore, the coefficients of determination are acceptable and the estimated coefficients have the correct signs as per economic theory.

The gender coefficients in the three “Females plus males” models of Table 5 are found to be equal to 0.155, 0.238 and 0.185 and they are significant at the 1% level of significance indicating that the hypothesis that gender resulted in significant difference in pay is supported. This shows that a male is expected to earn 15.5%, 23.8%, or 18.5% more than a female.

In the second round of regressions, the results of the regression will be grouped in accordance with the years of experience, i.e. different regression models are obtained each within a certain experience category as shown in Table 6. By working with data corresponding to each experience category, we can observe the variations of the “Betas”, and thus estimate how salaries vary with variations of gender and education.

Table 6. Table of Coefficients

Experience Interval for both banks	N	β_1 p-value	β_2 p-value	β_3 p-value	β_4 p-value	β_5 p-value	R ²	Adjusted R ²
<i>Experience</i> ≤ 4	243	8.405 0.000	-0.153 0.135	0.157 0.000	0.141 0.042	0.064 0.008	0.137	0.122
4 < <i>Experience</i> ≤ 15	250	8.333 0.000	0.034 0.676	0.248 0.000	0.206 0.009	-0.001 0.768	0.203	0.19
15 < <i>Experience</i> ≤ 22	234	10.743 0.000	-0.265 0.381	0.260 0.000	0.236 0.000	0.008 0.300	0.447	0.437
<i>Experience</i> > 22	229	7.445 0.000	0.084 0.202	0.273 0.000	0.147 0.011	-0.001 0.442	0.412	0.402

Table 6 shows the results of four regressions performed on four experience strata of the combined data of both banks. The experience strata are designed based on the approximate quartile divisions of the experience years for the 956 combined records. The results clearly demonstrate how ‘ β_4 ’, the gender coefficient varies with experience. It is clearly seen that at middle years of experience ‘ β_4 ’ increases indicating a wider gap in earnings between males and females with males making up to 23.6% more than females. At lower and higher categories of experience, the gap narrows making the females salaries lower only by some 14%. Notice that in the four regressions performed in Table 6, the experience coefficient and in general the experience squared coefficient are not significant at 5% level of significance.

Similar results were obtained by repeating regression analysis performed on four identical experience strata from the 633 records of the medium bank and 323 records of the small bank. For both banks, the results are identical in how at middle years of experience ‘ β_4 ’ increases indicating a wider gap in earnings between males and females with males making up to 21 % more than females for the medium bank and 43.1% for the small bank. At lower and higher categories of experience, the gap narrows making the females salaries lower only by some 16.5% for the medium bank and approximately equivalent to those of males due to the insignificant gender coefficients in the small bank. Worth mentioning that in most of the regression cases that correspond to data from both banks, the experience coefficient and the experience squared coefficient are not significant at 5% level of significance.

4. Discussion

Looking carefully at the four regressions under the four experience categories for both banks; Table 6 shows that under the four categories of experience the gender coefficients are statistically significant at the 5% level and the earning gap is lower near low and higher years of experience. The coefficients for the categories of medium years of experience i.e. intervals 4 to 15 years and 15 to 22 years are 20.6% (p-value=0.009), and 23.6% (p-value=0.000) respectively. These indicate that a women's wage is on the average 20.6% (or 23.6%) below a comparable man's wage. Therefore, apparently, it looks like, the ideas of "Sticky Floors" and "Glass Ceilings" are not sharply present.

Likewise, in the medium size bank; results confirm that the earnings gap is lower near low and high years of experience. In fact, the gender coefficient for the category of medium years of experience i.e. the interval between 4 and 15 years is 21% (p-value=0.034). This indicates that a female's wage is on the average 21% below a comparable male's wage. Again, there is evidence to say that apparently the ideas of "Sticky Floors" and "Glass Ceilings" exist but they are not the most critical.

Finally, to reinforce more the findings, the regressions performed on the records of the small bank show that earning gaps are wider in the categories of medium years of experience. Indeed, for the experience interval 4 to 15 years, the gender coefficient is 26.5% (p-value=0.066) suggesting that a women's wage is on the average 26.5% below a comparable man's wage. Similarly, for the experience interval 15 to 22 years, the gender coefficient is 43.1% (p-value=0.000) implying that a women's wage is on the average 43.1% below a comparable man's wage.

Results corresponding to regression analysis for both banks, the medium bank and the small bank respectively show that the earning gaps are narrower at the categories of low experience (below 4 years) and high experience (above 22 years). This behaviour of the earning clearly leads to the conclusion that a sticky floor or a glass ceiling do exist but cannot be considered the major discrimination traits of the banking sector in Lebanon.

Under the lowest category of experience (Experience ≤ 4 years), the gender coefficients are: 14.1% (p-value = 0.042), 11.8% (p-value = 0.118) and 18.4% (p-value=0.261) for data from both banks, the medium bank and the small bank respectively. These gender coefficients when significant mean that a male is expected to earn more than a female when holding other things constant. The point to emphasize is that these earnings gaps are narrower than the aforementioned gaps at medium years of experience.

Likewise, for the highest category of experience (Experience > 22 years), the gender coefficients are: 14.7% (p-value = 0.011), 16.5% (p-value = 0.003) and 16.5% (p-value=0.238) for data from both banks, the medium bank and the small bank respectively. These coefficients when significant mean that a male employee is expected to earn more than a female employee holding other things constant. Once again, the point to emphasize is that these earnings gaps are narrower than the aforementioned gaps at medium years of experience.

These outcomes clearly demonstrate that on one hand as the number of years of experience decreases, the level of discrimination between males and females decreases and the effect of a sticky floor is not very lustrous; and that on the other hand, as the number of years of experience increases, the level of discrimination between males and females decreases making the effect of a glass ceiling gloomy.

Is there a self-correcting mechanism in the Lebanese banking sector in particular? Apparently there is no evidence of any self-correcting mechanism within the considered banking sector. The wage gap seems to be weaker with lower or greater experience, meaning that the gap that exists upon arrival is widened for some years and then it shrinks again to almost the same as that present upon arrival.

5. Conclusions

Females form approximately 40% of the banking labor force within the Lebanese labor market. On average females earn USD 14,722 (Median = USD 11,694) as compared to USD 19,285 (Median = USD 12,564), that indicates that average-wise a female earns around 76% of what a male earns. The models presented have revealed that the income inequity gap is reduced but not eliminated with higher and lower years of experience.

There is no evidence of any established correcting mechanism for wage gaps in the Lebanese labor market. The gap that exists upon arrival to the labor market due to the traditional masculine stereotype concept (Eagly & Sczesny, 2009, p. 25) is widened as experience increases, probably through discriminatory promotion policies. This gap diminishes as women advance into leadership roles.

Accordingly, this research concludes that women in the Lebanese banking sector suffer more from intermediate discrimination while being in the intermediate years of service. Therefore, both the “Sticky floor” and the “Glass Ceiling” although present, are not the dominant discrimination outcome. It has been shown that the major discrimination occurs while climbing the ladder up, this should call for government intervention programs to eliminate such discrimination.

Finally, the findings of this research are consistent with the results of (Madalozzo, 2010): “Men are better paid than women. The trend of a decreasing gap remains, but is losing pace over time. The difference in pay is decreasing but still a significant 15.4% on average in 2007”.

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